How do plants reproduce?

Background

fertilisation say ('furr-til-iz-ay-shen') – the merging (joining) of the male and female reproductive cells

All plants and animals reproduce. Reproduction may be **asexual** (without sex) or **sexual**.

A plant that reproduces asexually produces a new plant by itself. The new plant is genetically identical to the parent plant. This is because it has the same **genes** as the parent plant. Genes are information carried in a living thing's cells that determines some of its characteristics.

A plant that reproduces sexually produces a new plant through **fertilisation**, either by itself or with another plant. The new plant is genetically different to both the parent plants, because it has a combination of the genes of its parents.

☞ **1** Fill in the missing vowels (a, e, i, o, u) to complete the sentences.

a) S __ x __ __ l r __ pr __ d __ ct __ __ n involves f __ rt __ l __ s __ t __ __ n, which is the joining of a m __ l __ reproductive cell and a f __ m __ l __ reproductive cell.

b) __ s __ x __ __ l r __ pr __ d __ ct __ __ n involves only one plant, which may form new tiny plants called plantlets or bulbs.

Pollination

Flowering plants reproduce through a process called **pollination**. Flowers contain the reproductive organs of a plant. Some plants have flowers with both male and female parts, while other plants have flowers with only male parts or only female parts.



The stamen is the male part of the flower. The pistil is the female part of the flower. The butterfly transfers pollen grains from the stamen to the pistil.

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Achieve!

How do plants reproduce? CONT'D

2 Fill in the blanks with the correct word from the word bank.

	Word bank
Some flowers contain tiny yellow grains called _____, which are male cells. This pollen is carried by bees, _____ or other insects to the female parts of the same or another _____.	butterflies flower pollen
The male and female parts _____ together in fertilisation. In this way, insects help to _____ flowers.	fertilise join
Fertilisation produces _____, which can develop into new _____. The plant develops these seeds inside its _____ and releases the fruit at certain times of the year.	fruit seeds plants
When the fruit _____ to the ground and _____, the seeds are released and go into the soil. When birds eat the fruit or seeds of a plant, the seeds _____ through the bird's digestive system and come out in its droppings. In this way, the seeds of plants can travel long distances from their parent plant.	rots travel falls

3 What is pollen? Circle the correct answer.

plant seeds flowers reproductive material fruit

4 Where are the seeds of a flowering plant? Circle the correct answer.

in its pollen in its fruit in its flowers in its stem

5 Name at least four types of animals that help flowers pollinate and spread their seeds.

_____ _____

_____ _____

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